

cool part—Thunderbird can actually *automatically* save or open attachments of certain types; you can specify what it should do.

Spam-busting is probably what Thunderbird is best-known for. You have a button on the main toolbar that allows you to mark a message as spam; and the spam filter learns, meaning that as time passes and you mark more and more messages as spam, it gets better and better. We haven't tested it, but reports say the spam filter works very well. Phishing protection has been implemented, too—so you get a warning right in your mail program that a message might be a phishing mail.

Like in Windows Live Mail, there's a search toolbar at the top for when you're looking for a particular message, but going beyond, you can save a search as a folder—and running the search again is as simple as clicking on that folder.

There are also the Back and Forward buttons on the toolbar, which are supposed to make it very convenient to go back and forth between the messages you read—much like in a browser. As in, when you press Back, you go to the message you read just before the current one. However, it's been reported that this feature may not always work correctly. When we tried it out, the buttons just remained greyed out.

Now, as you might know, it's not always safe to download images in e-mails, especially if you don't know the sender. By default, Thunderbird blocks images from loading, and the message window appears like the one alongside.

Now the same thing happens in Outlook Express, and you can click a button to load the images. However, in Thunderbird, you can



Tools > Options is usually boring—not so here



Images are blocked by default in Thunderbird